Sinners in the Hands of an Angry God

Jonathan Edwards · July 8, 1741

Source: Jonathan Edwards, "Sinners in the Hands of an Angry God" (1741). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> The most famous sermon of the Great Awakening: with vivid images of sinners dangled like a spider over the fire, Edwards preached that only God's mercy holds the unconverted from hell — stirring a wave of emotional religious revival.

There is nothing between you and hell but the air; it is only the power and mere pleasure of God that holds you up. . . . The God that holds you over the pit of hell, much as one holds a spider or loathsome insect over the fire, abhors you, and is dreadfully provoked; his wrath towards you burns like fire; and yet it is nothing but his hand that holds you from falling into the fire every moment.